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Electromagnetic brake device

Abstract

An electromagnetic brake device includes an armature rotatably supported about a rotational axis; a yoke including a groove, an inner cylinder portion, and an outer cylinder portion; and a coil arranged in the groove and configured to generate a magnetic force when energized and thereby attract the armature to the yoke. A first opposing surface of the armature facing the yoke includes a sliding surface configured to slide on the outer cylinder portion of the yoke, and a recessed portion disposed inward of the sliding surface in a radial direction and recessed in a direction away from the yoke. An inner perimeter area of a second opposing surface of the outer cylinder portion of the yoke and a third opposing surface of the inner cylinder portion of the yoke face the recessed portion of the armature and do not contact the first opposing surface of the armature.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of International Application No. PCT/JP2021/017297, filed on Apr. 30, 2021 and designating the U.S., which claims priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-081953, filed on May 7, 2020. The contents of these applications are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(1) The present disclosure relates to electromagnetic brake devices.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) Conventionally, a gear shift device that enables a transmission to be shifted by a rotation operation via a knob is used in, for example, a vehicle such as an automobile. Also, conventionally, a technique that uses an electromagnetic brake device to brake the rotation of the knob is used in such a gear shift device.

(3) For example, Patent Document 1 discloses a technique in which the rotation of an operation knob and a rotary shaft is braked by causing the lower surface of an armature that rotates integrally with the operation knob and the rotary shaft to be attracted to the end surface of an external yoke portion of a yoke core based on the magnetic force generated from a coil.

(4) However, in technique disclosed in Patent Document 1, burrs can form on an inner perimeter area of the end surface when a cutting process is performed to form the end surface of the external yoke. In such a case, the burrs can contact the lower surface of the armature when the armature is rotating. This may reduce the brake torque, may damage the paint on the lower surface of the armature such that it increases friction during a non-conductive state, or may reduce durability.

RELATED-ART DOCUMENTS

Patent Documents

(5) Patent Document 1: Japanese Patent Application No. 2013-160356

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(6) An electromagnetic brake device according to one embodiment includes an armature rotatably supported about a rotational axis; a yoke including a groove formed in an annular shape and centered on the rotational axis, an inner cylinder portion having a substantially cylindrical shape and disposed inward of the groove in a radial direction, and an outer cylinder portion having a substantially cylindrical shape and disposed outward of the groove in the radial direction; and a coil arranged in the groove and configured to generate a magnetic force when energized and thereby attract the armature to the yoke. A first opposing surface of the armature facing the yoke includes a sliding surface configured to slide on the outer cylinder portion of the yoke, and a recessed portion disposed inward of the sliding surface in the radial direction and recessed in a direction away from the yoke. An inner perimeter area of a second opposing surface of the outer cylinder portion of the yoke facing the armature and a third opposing surface of the inner cylinder portion of the yoke facing the armature are arranged to face the recessed portion of the armature and do not contact the first opposing surface of the armature.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Other objects and further features of the present invention will be apparent from the following detailed description when read in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a cross section parallel to the XZ plane of an electromagnetic brake device according to one embodiment; and

(3) FIG. 2. is a partially enlarged cross-sectional view illustrating an enlarged view of a portion A of the electromagnetic brake device illustrated in FIG. 1.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(4) According to one embodiment, it is possible to inhibit a reduction in brake torque or damage to the coating on a lower surface of an armature due to the presence of burrs on an inner perimeter area of a yoke.

(5) The embodiment of the present invention will be described hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings. In the following description, assume that the Z-axis direction (the axis direction of a rotational axis AX) in each drawing indicates the vertical direction, and the X-axis direction and the Y-axis direction (directions perpendicular to the axis direction of the rotational axis AX) in each drawing indicate the horizontal direction.

Outline of Electromagnetic Brake Device 100

(6) FIG. 1 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a cross section parallel to the XZ plane of an electromagnetic brake device 100 according to the embodiment. The electromagnetic brake device 100 illustrated in FIG. 1 is a device that is arranged coaxially with the rotational axis AX of a rotary shaft 10 and is configured to brake the rotation of the rotary shaft 10. As illustrated in FIG. 1, the electromagnetic brake device 100 includes the rotary shaft 10, an armature 110, a yoke 120, and a coil 130.

(7) The electromagnetic brake device 100 is used in, for example, a gear shift device that enables a transmission to be shifted by a rotation operation via a knob (illustration omitted). In this case, for example, the electromagnetic brake device 100 is attached to the rotary shaft 10 that rotates in conjunction with the rotation of the operation knob, and the armature 110 is coupled to the rotary shaft 10 so as to be movable in the vertical direction (Z-axis direction) but is fixed in the rotation direction. The electromagnetic brake device 100 brakes the rotation of the operation knob and the rotary shaft 10 by attracting the armature 110 to the yoke 120 based on the magnetic force generated by the coil 130. However, application of the electromagnetic brake device 100 is not limited to the gear shift device. The electromagnetic brake device 100 may be used in any device that includes at least the rotary shaft 10.

(8) The armature 110 is a disc-shaped member. The armature 110 includes a through hole 111 that is centered on the rotational axis AX and passes through the armature 110 in the vertical direction (Z-axis direction). The inner diameter of the through hole 111 is substantially the same as the outer diameter of the rotary shaft 10. Also, although not illustrated in the drawings, the through hole 111 has, for example, a D-profile shape extending in the rotation-axis direction that prevents rotation with respect to the rotation direction. Hence, the armature 110 is able to move up and down with respect to the rotary shaft 10, and is able to rotate integrally with the rotary shaft 10 with respect to the rotation direction. The rotary shaft 10 is inserted in the armature 110 such that the armature 110 is rotatably supported about the rotational axis AX by the rotary shaft 10 (or by another member that rotates integrally with the rotary shaft 10). Hence, the armature 110 rotates integrally with the rotary shaft 10 about the rotational axis AX.

(9) The armature 110 includes a disc-shaped first opposing surface 112 that faces the yoke 120 in a plan view. An annular sliding surface 112A is arranged on a radially outer portion of the first opposing surface 112. The sliding surface 112A faces and contacts a second opposing surface 123A of an outer cylinder portion 123 of the yoke 120. Hence, the sliding surface 112A slides on the second opposing surface 123A when the armature 110 rotates.

(10) A recessed portion 112B that is circular in a plan view and is recessed in a direction (a positive Z-axis direction) away from the yoke 120 is formed on a portion of the first opposing surface 112 of the armature 110 that is inward of the sliding surface 112A in the radial direction. Hence, the portion of the first opposing surface 112 of the armature 110 that is disposed inward of the sliding surface 112A in the radial direction is slightly separated from a third opposing surface 124A of an inner cylinder portion 124 of the yoke 120 so as not to contact the third opposing surface 124A.

(11) For example, the armature **110** may be made of a magnetic material (for example, iron) so that the armature **110** can be attracted to the yoke **120** based on the magnetic force generated by the coil **130**.
(12) The yoke **120** is a cylindrical member that is arranged below the armature **110** and is made of a magnetic material (for example, iron). The yoke **120** forms a magnetic circuit that passes through the inner cylinder portion **124**, the outer cylinder portion **123**, and the armature **110**, thus attracting the armature **110** based on the magnetic force generated by the coil **130**. Hence, the rotation of the armature **110** can be braked by the yoke **120**.

(13) The yoke **120** includes a circular through hole **121** centered on the rotational axis AX. The through hole **121** passes through the yoke **120** in the vertical direction (the Z-axis direction). The inner diameter of the through hole **121** is substantially the same as the outer diameter of the rotary shaft **10**. The rotary shaft **10** that rotates integrally with the armature **110** is inserted in the through hole **121**. However, since the yoke **120** is not fixed to the rotary shaft **10**, the yoke **120** does not rotate integrally with the rotary shaft **10**.

(14) In addition, the yoke **120** includes a groove **122** that has been formed by cutting the upper surface of the yoke **120** downward (in the negative Z-axis direction) into an annular recessed shape centered on the rotational axis AX. Hence, the yoke **120** includes the outer cylinder portion **123**, which has a substantially cylindrical shape and is disposed further outward of the groove **122** in the radial direction, and an inner cylinder portion **124**, which has a substantially cylindrical shape and is disposed inward of the groove **122** in the radial direction.

(15) The yoke **120** is formed by powder metallurgy. By powder metallurgy, even metals that are difficult to machine in bulk or materials that are poorly soluble can be formed into complex shapes with high precision. The opposing surfaces of the yoke **120** that face the armature **110** are formed to be flush with each other (that is, to be the same height as each other) in the Z direction. However, the opposing surfaces of the yoke **120** that face the armature **110** are divided by the groove **122** into the second opposing surface **123A** of the outer cylinder portion **123**, which faces the armature **110**, and the third opposing surface **124A** of the inner cylinder portion **124**, which faces the armature **110**.

(16) The coil **130** is formed into a cylindrical shape by winding a wire multiple times in the groove **122** of the yoke **120**. The coil **130** generates a magnetic force when energized, and the magnetic force attracts the armature **110** to the yoke **120**. As a result, the electromagnetic brake device **100** is able to brake the rotation of the rotary shaft **10** that rotates integrally with the armature **110**. That is, the rotation of the operation knob that rotates in conjunction with the rotation of the rotary shaft **10** can be braked.

(17) FIG. 2 is a partially enlarged cross-sectional view illustrating an enlarged view of a portion A of the electromagnetic brake device **100** illustrated in FIG. 1.

(18) As illustrated in FIG. 2, the third opposing surface **124A** of the inner cylinder portion **124** of the yoke **120** faces the recessed portion **112B** of the first opposing surface **112** of the armature **110**. Hence, the third opposing surface **124A** is spaced apart from the first opposing surface **112** (a back surface **112Ba** of the recessed portion **112B**) with a very narrow predetermined gap (for example, 0.05 mm) interposed therebetween. That is, the third opposing surface **124A** does not contact the first opposing surface **112**. Thus, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, even if the precision (such as the flatness) of the components of the armature **110** varies, the armature **110** does not contact the third opposing surface **124A** of the yoke **120** that is disposed in the inner portion of the yoke **120** in the radial direction. Therefore, reduction in the attraction force for attracting the armature **110** can be inhibited while reducing the rotation load of the armature **110**.

(19) In addition, as illustrated in FIG. 2, the sliding surface **112A** of the armature **110** faces and contacts the second opposing surface **123A** of the outer cylinder portion **123** of the yoke **120**. Hence, the sliding surface **112A** of the armature **110** slides on the second opposing surface **123A** in accordance with the rotation of the armature **110**.

(20) The sliding surface **112A** is coated with a urethane-based baked-on paint. As a result, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, the coefficient of friction between the sliding surface **112A** and the second opposing surface **123A** may decrease during a non-braking state in which the magnetic braking force is not applied, and the coefficient of friction between the sliding surface **112A** and the second opposing surface **123A** may increase during a braking state in which the magnetic braking force is applied.

(21) In addition, as illustrated in FIG. 2, an inner perimeter area **123Aa** (a portion of the second opposing surface **123A** bordering the groove **122**) of the second opposing surface **123A** of the yoke **120** is arranged at a position facing the recessed portion **112B** of the first opposing surface **112** of the armature **110**. Hence, the inner perimeter area **123Aa** of the second opposing surface **123A** is spaced apart from the first opposing surface **112** (the back surface **112Ba** of the recessed portion **112B**) of the armature **110**. That is, the inner perimeter area **123Aa** does not contact the first opposing surface **112**.

(22) Hence, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, even if burrs are generated on the inner perimeter area **123Aa** of the second opposing surface **123A** during machining to flatten the surface height, the first opposing surface **112** does not contact the burrs on the inner perimeter area **123Aa** when the armature **110** is rotating. Therefore, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, it is possible to inhibit a reduction in brake torque or damage to the urethane-based baked-on paint on the sliding surface **112A** due to the presence of the burrs on the inner perimeter area **123Aa**.

(23) Also, as illustrated in FIG. 2, the inner perimeter area **112Aa** (a portion of the sliding surface **112A** bordering the recessed portion **112B**) of the sliding surface **112A** of the armature **110** is arranged further inward from the inner perimeter area **123Aa** of the second opposing surface **123A** in the radial direction by a predetermined distance (for example, 1.0 mm). Hence, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, even even if burrs are generated on the inner perimeter area **123Aa** of the second opposing surface **123A** during machining, the sliding surface **112A** does not contact the burrs on the inner perimeter area **123Aa** when the armature **110** is rotating. Therefore, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, it is possible to inhibit influence on brake torque or damage to the urethane-based baked paint on the sliding surface **112A** due to the presence of the burrs on the inner perimeter area **123Aa**.

(24) In addition, as illustrated in FIG. 2, an outer perimeter area **112Ab** (an outermost radial portion of the sliding surface **112A**) of the sliding surface **112A** of the armature **110** is disposed inward of an outer perimeter area **123Ab** (an outermost radial portion of the second opposing surface **123A**) of the second opposing surface **123A** in the radial direction. Hence, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, even if burrs are generated on the outer perimeter area **123Ab** of the second opposing surface **123A** during machining, the sliding surface **112A** does not contact the burrs on the outer perimeter area **123Ab** when the armature **110** is rotating. Therefore, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, it is possible to inhibit influence on brake torque or damage to the urethane-based baked-on paint on the sliding surface **112A** due to the presence of burrs on the inner perimeter area **123Aa**.

(25) Furthermore, as illustrated in FIG. 2, the first opposing surface **112** of the armature **110** includes a step **112C** on a boundary between the sliding surface **112A** and the back surface **112Ba** of the recessed portion **112B**. Thus, the first opposing surface **112** of the armature **110** is not flat with respect to the height direction. In contrast, the second opposing surface **123A** is flush with the third opposing surface **124A** of the yoke **120** in the height direction. Hence, since the yoke **120** that has a complex shape is flattened in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, processing can be performed more easily as compared to a case where a step is formed on the yoke **120**, and thus a gap can be formed between the armature **110** and the yoke **120** with relatively high accuracy.

(26) Therefore, in the electromagnetic brake device **100** according to the embodiment, the yoke **120** can be formed to have a complex shape, and secondary processing can be easily performed on the yoke **120**.

(27) Although the embodiment of the present invention has been described above, the present invention is not limited to this. Various changes and modifications can be made without departing from the scope of the present invention as described in the appended claims.

(28) For example, although the recessed portion **112B** according to the embodiment is a circular recessed portion that has a uniform depth, the recessed portion **112B** may be divided into an annular recessed portion that faces the inner perimeter area **123Aa** of the second opposing surface **123A** and a circular recessed portion that faces the third opposing surface **124A**. Furthermore, the depths and the shapes of the recessed portions may be configured to differ from each other.

Claims

1. An electromagnetic brake device comprising: an armature rotatably supported about a rotational axis; a yoke including a groove formed in an annular shape and centered on the rotational axis, an inner cylinder portion having a substantially cylindrical shape and disposed inward of the groove in a radial direction, and an outer cylinder portion having a substantially cylindrical shape and disposed outward of the groove in the radial direction; and a coil arranged in the groove and configured to generate a magnetic force when energized and thereby attract the armature to the yoke, wherein a first opposing surface of the armature facing the yoke includes sliding surface configured to slide on the outer cylinder portion of the yoke, and a recessed portion is disposed inward of the sliding surface in the radial direction and recessed in a direction away from the yoke, wherein an inner perimeter area of a second opposing surface of the outer cylinder portion of the yoke facing the armature and a third opposing surface of the inner cylinder portion of the yoke facing the armature are arranged to face the recessed portion of the armature and do not contact the first opposing surface of the armature, and wherein an outer perimeter area of the sliding surface of the armature is disposed inward of an outer perimeter area of the second opposing surface of the yoke in the radial direction.
 2. The electromagnetic brake device according to claim 1, wherein the first opposing surface of the armature includes a step on a boundary between the sliding surface and a back surface of the recessed portion, and the second opposing surface is formed to be flush with the third opposing surface of the yoke.
 3. The electromagnetic brake device according to claim 1, wherein the yoke is formed by powder metallurgy.
 4. The electromagnetic brake device according to claim 1, wherein at least one of the sliding surface of the armature or the second opposing surface of the yoke is coated with a urethane-based baked-on paint.
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